

100m qualification for the Asian Games. The performance instead showed the speed Abinaya can bring to India's relay campaign when the Games begin in Aichi-Nagoya four weeks later.

Harita Bhadra finished second in 11.46 and Sneha Sathyanarayana third in 11.56.

"I was about to cry. I knew I would break the national record someday, but today's time is also crazy," Abinaya said. "Coming back from injury, I ran a good race. I'll leave it up to God. I'm disappointed, but it's okay." The Asian U-18 and 2025 Asian Championships relay silver medallist had turned a setback into a possibility.

For those bound for Japan, the evening was less about selection than form. Rohit Yadav supplied the strongest evidence, improving his 87.05m best to 87.68m. It put him in the medal conversation. But a likely field containing Neeraj Chopra, Arshad Nadeem and Sri Lanka's 90m thrower Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage leaves little certainty. Yashvir Singh's 82.94m, ahead of Sumedha Ranasinghe's 80.29m, kept him competitive in that company.

Vithya Ramraj controlled the women's 400m in a personal best of 51.96. Bahrain's world-class quarter-milers keep the standard high, but the performance strengthened Vithya's case as a finalist and medal contender. Prachi's 52.57 and M.R. Poovamma's 52.78 also encouraged the relay squad.

Ancy Sojan led a women's long jump sweep for India with 6.71m, ahead of Shaili Singh (6.56m) and Mubassina Mohammed (6.31m). Although 17cm short of her 6.88m national record, the mark keeps Ancy in the Asian Games medal discussion.



**Winning leap:** Murali Sreeshankar soared to a winning 8.07m, keeping himself firmly in the Asian Games conversation. PICS: BISWARANJAN ROUT